project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER



Information Detective!

Grades 3–5 · Library

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

The history of hoaxes. From spirit photography to deepfakes, people have always found ways to fool others with fake images and information. Understanding history helps us recognize modern tricks.

01

PART 1

Research a historical hoax

Choose one famous hoax to research:

- ◯ Spirit Photography (William Mumler, 1860s)
- ◯ The Cottingley Fairies (1917 — fake fairy photos)
- ◯ The Cardiff Giant (1869 — fake giant fossil)
- ◯ The Loch Ness Monster "Surgeon's Photo" (1934)

Hoax I'm researching: _____

What was the hoax? How did it fool people?

How was it eventually exposed as fake?

What lesson does this teach us today?

02

PART 2

Create a misinformation awareness guide

Design a mini-poster for younger students (Grades 1–2) teaching them ONE important rule about not being fooled. Include: a catchy title, simple language, a picture or example, one action they can take.

DESIGN YOUR GUIDE HERE

03

PART 3

Critical question

Technology keeps making it easier to create convincing fakes. What skills will ALWAYS be useful, no matter what new technology appears?

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Share what you learned about your historical hoax with your family. Ask them: *"What hoaxes or fake information have YOU encountered?"*

Visit: minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions